

Prakash Arun Narkhede

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Professional Summary

Principal QA Automation Architect with 16+ years of experience building test automation platforms for enterprise SaaS products. Currently own the automation architecture for a Salesforce ecosystem across multiple orgs, covering Sales Cloud, integrations, APIs and downstream systems. Built a retrieval-augmented generation platform that writes test scenarios, cases and code, cutting test design cycle time by 30 to 40 percent.

Impact Snapshot

- Centralised automation framework adopted across enterprise-scale project portfolio, covering Web, API, database and Salesforce layers.
- Production-grade monitoring system, built in-house, which removed the dependency on an external APM vendor.
- 35% projected reduction in test creation and maintenance effort, validated through a hands-on multi-vendor platform evaluation for a 20-engineer group.
- AI test generation platform reaching 80%+ accuracy, with human review gates on every output before hand-off.

AI and Innovation Leadership

- **RAG Test Generation Platform (Databricks)**
 - Designed and implemented an in-house platform producing test scenarios, cases and code from requirements and metadata using hybrid retrieval. [req - scenario - tests - automation - reporting]
 - Achieved 80%+ generation accuracy and cut test design cycle time by 30 to 40%.
 - Cleared enterprise architecture and security reviews; every artefact requires human review before hand-off.
- **Testing Strategy for LLM Agents**
 - Defined deterministic verification against systems of record for factual answers using typed comparators.
 - Reserved AI-graded scoring exclusively for subjective qualities (tone, relevance) since probabilistic metrics cannot gate releases.
 - Chose deterministic evaluation over end-to-end prompt replay to avoid model fragility and ensure clear root cause signals.
- **Agentic IDE Test Authoring**
 - Designed implemented Test Planner, Test Generator and Test Reviewer agents embedded in the IDE, saving 80% time of automation engineers. Skill based agents, utilizing various helpers, guardrails.
 - Enforced explicit approval gates and rules preventing agents from inventing unmapped identifiers.
- **Synthetic Test Data Agent**
 - Built a metadata-grounded agent drawing constraints from the Salesforce metadata API.
 - Removed data setup bottlenecks without requiring write access to live systems.
- **Go-To-Market QA AI Strategy**
 - Defined and owned the AI strategy covering six workstreams and various AI agents for the test lifecycle.
 - Transitioned the team from ad-hoc tool use to a governed workflow with mandatory human review on all AI outputs.

Technical Skills

Test Automation	Copado CRT, Robot Framework, Playwright, Selenium, RestAssured, TOSCA, Cucumber
AI Engineering	RAG architecture, hybrid retrieval, prompt engineering, LLM-as-judge evaluation, agent design, MCP integrations
Salesforce	Sales/service Cloud, SOQL, Metadata API, JWT authentication, multi-sandbox management
Cloud and CI/CD	AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, Secrets Manager), Opsera, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, Docker
Languages	Python, Java, SQL
Test Management	Jira, Confluence, qTest

Experience

Workday	<i>Pune, India</i>
<i>Principal QA Automation Architect</i>	Sept 2024 to Present

- Own the automation technical strategy and quality benchmarks for the Go-To-Market technology division, setting coverage targets and review cadence for leads from all projects under Go-To-Market QA.
- Architect end-to-end automation for the Salesforce ecosystem: Sales Cloud, integrations, APIs and downstream systems, spanning multiple orgs and environments.
- Constructed reusable automation components in Copado CRT and Robot Framework alongside the existing TOSCA estate, building a common framework supporting multiple other projects and reducing per-project setup from weeks to days.
- Wired CI/CD automation pipelines into Opsera, enabling regression runs to trigger on every deployment across four environments.
- Ran a multi-vendor platform evaluation with hands-on proof of concept builds, then produced the quantified ROI model that drove the platform decision. 35% projected reduction in creation and maintenance effort. Did not select the cheapest option because its API coverage was too narrow for the Salesforce metadata layer.
- Implemented data-driven validation that record-level access restrictions on core revenue objects are enforced per persona, combining REST API assertions with UI flows across three security profiles.
- Built execution report consolidation for daily scheduled runs of 10,000+ tests across Copado CRT (Robotic Testing) and TOSCA, including automated failure categorisation and Slack delivery, reducing manual analysis effort by 80%+.
- Authored automation guidelines and governance standards for the division: naming conventions, job structure, review cadence. Reduced flaky test volume by approximately 25% in the first quarter.

Wolters Kluwer	<i>Pune, India</i>
<i>Test Automation Manager</i>	Mar 2020 to Sept 2024

- Managed automation delivery across a suite of products including SAP ECC and Salesforce integrations, with capacity planning for eight concurrent programmes.
- Developed and maintained a centralised test automation framework used by enterprise-scale projects, covering Web, API, database and Salesforce test layers.
- Built a production-grade monitoring system running around the clock, eliminating the dependency on an external APM tool and cutting related operational cost by approximately 30%.
- Deployed TOSCA and Selenium WebDriver across the product portfolio, reducing manual regression cycles from five days to under two days per release.
- Established CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins, Docker and Selenium Grid on AWS, handling over 2,000 automated test runs per week.

HSBC Technology India	<i>Pune, India</i>
<i>Sr. Software Engineer</i>	Jun 2015 to Mar 2020

- Automated regression suites for cross-border tax reporting systems (FATCA, CRS), covering 12 jurisdictions and three upstream data feeds.

- Designed multiple test automation frameworks using Selenium and Cucumber, cutting manual regression effort by roughly 40%.
- Coordinated test execution and defect triage across teams in Pune, Guangzhou and London, supporting four releases per year.

IBM India

Software Engineer, Banking Client

Pune, India

Apr 2012 to Mar 2015

- Executed end-to-end system integration and regression testing across mainframe and web layers, and automated mainframe test workflows using REXX, cutting overnight batch validation from six hours to under two.
- Coordinated defect reports between onsite and offshore teams across three time zones for a Tier 1 banking client.

ISBM School of Technology

Lecturer and Business Analyst

Pune, India

Jun 2010 to Mar 2012

- Taught C++ and Digital Electronics while also serving as Business Analyst for in-house IT projects, gathering requirements for College software, utilized by admin, staff & students.

Education and Certifications

- B.E. in Electronics and Telecommunication, University of Pune.
- ISTQB (Foundation and Advanced), TOSCA Architect Certified, Copado Robotic Testing Certified, Python PCEP, qTest Certified.